GRC Vendor Implementation Success Strategies

Published: August 2015 **Report Number:** A0166

Analyst: David Houlihan, Principal Analyst

Share This Report

What You Need To Know

Governance, risk, and compliance (GRC) platforms support organizations in the management of information complexity, process execution, and stakeholder coordination in support of compliance management, risk mitigation, and corporate assurance needs. Blue Hill's The Hidden Costs of Spreadsheets in Compliance and Risk Management study found that the benefits resulting from GRC implementation range between 25% and 30% in time saved in compliance and risk activities, increased visibility into changing activities and reporting, and reduced risk exposure.

However, as with any enterprise application, GRC implementation requires significant process change, solution tailoring, and internal deployment and adoption. While not unique challenges, the degree to which GRC relies on indirect value propositions means that the cost and difficulty of implementation possesses expanded importance in determining organizational value and satisfaction. As GRC vendors seek to respond to these needs, new approaches to minimize implementation pain and maximize time to value are emerging. Blue Hill analysis of implementation has identified five such strategies impacting implementation speed and cost: (1) rapid solution deployment strategy, (2) configurability, (3) out-of-the-box components, (4) cloud and hosted deployment, and (5) SaaS pricing models. This report reviews these trends and provides a Solution Landscape highlighting GRC vendors demonstrating effective use of these strategies.

AT A GLANCE

Business Challenges

Process change, solution tailoring, deployment, and cultural acceptance represent key pain points in any enterprise application deployment. For GRC platforms, which often operate on indirect, cost avoidance-based value propositions, these factors often have a significant impact on the perceived value of and satisfaction with the implementation. As the GRC market has matured, responsiveness to implementation challenges has become an increasingly important point of solution differentiation.

Solution Landscape Scope

This report surveys eleven GRC platform vendors identified in Blue Hill research and analysis as providing strong emphasis on customer success in GRC platform implementation.

Key Elements of Implementation Support

- Rapid deployment program
- Product configurability
- Out-of-the-box functionality
- Cloud or hosted deployment options
- Software-as-a-Service delivery models

Market Context: Factors Impacting GRC Implementation

GRC is an information and process management platform supporting compliance management, risk management, and assurance activities. The primary value contributed results from improvements in the efficiency of corresponding stakeholders as well as improved insight into changes in risk factors, which ultimately helps to mitigate risks and reduce associated costs. Blue Hill's The Hidden Costs of Spreadsheets in Compliance and Risk Management

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

study found that the adoption of GRC results in between 25% and 30% in time saved in compliance and risk activities as well as improved clarity and timeliness of insight.

As with all enterprise application investments, obtaining the value offered by GRC can require significant process change, integration with the existing enterprise ecosystem, and solution tailoring to fit organizational needs. The cost and time required to complete these activities impact the time to value as well as long-term return on investment (ROI) of the solution. These dynamics are not unique to GRC. However, the degree to which GRC relies on indirect and difficult-to-measure value propositions rooted in cost avoidance and risk mitigation means that the cost and hardship that occur in implementation often have inflated importance in determining the perceived value and satisfaction of the solution.

The factors that contribute to the cost and complexity of a GRC implementation emerge from a variety of sources. The scope of solution functionality as well as organizational operations and stakeholders to be included often represent the most immediate factors. However, the degree of solution tailoring required to fit the organization's needs, information models, and processes often plays a more crucial role. Blue Hill's Benchmark Report: How to Avoid the Worst-Case GRC Implementation reviewed twenty-one GRC implementations to isolate "Best Case" and "Worst Case" experiences based on a combination of implementation time, implementation cost, and business and user satisfaction. Table 1 profiles the range of experiences reported by each group with respect to these categories.

This does not mean that GRC investment is entirely dependent on implementation time and cost. In fact, many complex and sophisticated implementations can and should require longer time cycles for effective implementation. Similarly, the implementation process is not as crucial an indicator of investment success as software quality or solution fit. Nonetheless, consideration of investment process efficiency and effectiveness appears as a crucial and often overlooked element of investment ROI and time-to-value.

Table 1: Profiles of Worst-Case and Best-Case Implementation Experiences

	Worst Case	Best Case
Time to Deployment	11 to 16 months	3 to 4 months
Cost of Implementation	$575,000 to $700,000	$75,000 to $180,000
Satisfaction with End-User Experience	Low to Moderate	High
Satisfaction with Business Impact	Moderate	High to Very High
Satisfaction with Ease of Implementation	Low	High to Very High

Source: Blue Hill Research, August 2015

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

Vendor Strategies to Support Implementation Effectiveness

Vendors offering GRC solutions must be cognizant of the challenges that impact implementation success as these issues have a direct impact on customer success, satisfaction, and long-term business growth. Solution characteristics, such as architecture, data model, workflow complexity, or in-built configurability all contribute to the ease of implementation. A vendor's product support, professional services, deployment methodology, and maturity roadmaps all play a role as well. While no single vendor approach may represent the "one best approach" to GRC implementation, an organization's consideration of these factors are as crucial to the ultimate implementation success and the ultimate value as the functionality and capabilities offered by the provider.

First-generation GRC platform providers, in particular, carry a reputation for requiring heavy customization and professional services engagements to ensure success. However, as the market has matured, vendors have looked for ways to differentiate themselves in the speed and effectiveness of the implementation experience. Blue Hill identifies five key components of vendor responses to the challenge of implementation complexity that were present within Best Case implementations reviewed in its Benchmark Report: How to Avoid the Worst-Case GRC Implementation:

- Efficient Implementation Support
- Solution Configurability
- Out-of-the-Box Capabilities
- Cloud and Hosted Deployment
- Software as a Service (SaaS) Pricing and Delivery Models

The following sections describe each of these factors in more detail. While each factor can contribute to reductions in implementation complexity and cost in different ways, Blue Hill finds that more successful GRC implementations often take advantage of a combination of some or all of these factors.

Efficient Implementation Support

Any enterprise application deployment will involve some support for implementation, training, and adoption processes. Where most vendors will provide strategic planning, customization, training, and other professional services, an increasing number promote rapid deployment programs, value prioritization guidance, or structured solution maturity roadmap planning support as a means of differentiation in response to GRC implementation challenges. Whatever form they take, the ultimate goal of these programs is to "stand up" a working GRC solution in as short a time as possible to help customers maximize time to value.

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

How a vendor makes these services available is a point of investigation as buyers consider the total cost of implementation, as some vendors will provide implementation support as a "professional services" line item, while others offer basic start-up services and support as included components of their basic agreements. In evaluating these aspects of a solution provider, organizations should consider the provider's proven success in assisting customers to rapidly deploy and realize value on implementations as well as the costs and pricing model associated. In addition, the availability of vendor-provided maturity frameworks and collection of user best practices and other peer expertise represent key elements for evaluation.

Solution Configurability

GRC provides a process and data management platform addressing a range of information types, frameworks, and organizational needs that can incorporate the management of a wider range of risks, controls, surveys, requirements, processes, documents, policies, standards, attestations, and other factors depending on an organization's compliance and risk management needs. However, in all cases, the basic solution components would be familiar in any enterprise application: (1) data elements, (2) data relationships, (3) workflow, (4) user interface, and (5) reports and dashboards. A large portion of a GRC implementation involves tailoring these various components to match the individual organizational and functional needs.

Increasingly, vendors provide configurable solutions in place of hard-coding, permitting administrative users to alter components within the solution. Blue Hill's Benchmark Report: How to Avoid the Worst-Case GRC Implementation found that preference for configurable solutions over customization represented the most significant contributor to differences in cost and implementation time identified in "Best Case" and "Worst Case" scenarios. Further, solution configurability also plays a role in long-term adaptability and scalability to fit developing needs, permitting organizations to adapt the solution over time to changing requirements and (where vendors also use scalable or modular platform models) to minimize the cost and effort required to expand the scope of implementation or add new functionality.

Organizations evaluating solution configurability or customization needs of GRC platforms should consider both the depth of configurability as well as the scope of configurable elements. While not necessarily appropriate in all circumstances, Blue Hill found that organizations deploying configurable solutions experienced approximately a quarter of the deployment time and one-third of the cost of organizations selecting customization. In addition,

Elements of GRC

Data Elements

Includes both individual data components themselves, such as: risks, controls, incidents, processes, and policies, as well as the characteristics and information fields used to define individual data components.

Data Relationships

Defines the hierarchies and interdependencies between data components. This defines how various data elements might be updated or altered based on changes in other data elements, such as risks, controls, or mitigation activities.

Process Workflow

Defines the structured progression of tasks between stakeholders in accordance with formalized processes. Workflow and processes often represent the largest area of individualized tailoring in implementation, and thus largest cost source.

User Interface

Defines how solution functionality and workflow are exposed to users. Tailoring options may be limited to "global" solution changes defining the environment for all users, or more granular personalization providing unique user interfaces to various roles and stakeholders.

Reports and Dashboards

Defines reporting functionality, dashboards, or other information presentation options. The goal here is to help ensure that stakeholders, particularly those that are not direct solution users, receive information that is needed. As with user interface, tailoring may be needed at the general implementation level or personalized by stakeholder.

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

organizations will wish to consider the vendor efforts to facilitate solution configuration, through graphical or drag-and-drop interfaces. At the same time, organizations will need to assess the depth of configuration options, to ensure that the solution possesses sufficient points of articulation to configure adequately. The ultimate value will depend on the scope and depth of both the tailoring needed and the configuration options provided by the vendor. Generally speaking, though organizations may often be primarily concerned with the configurability of reporting and process workflow, all core solution elements of a GRC platform may be considered.

Out-of-the-Box Capabilities

While GRC can involve a great deal of individualized permutations depending on an organization's needs, it can also involve a number of established standards, requirements, or frameworks that do not change from organization to organization. Regulations such as HIPAA, Sarbanes-Oxley, or FERC as well as industry standards such as ISO, COBIT, and COSO frameworks define processes and activities that generally remain unchanged among affected organizations. GRC platforms may incorporate these requirements and standards as embedded content frameworks. In addition, vendors have made efforts to incorporate customer insights, industry vertical-specific workflows and experiences, and other identified best practices such as curated peer communities, pre-built process workflows, reports, data models, templates, methodologies, and content libraries. By and large, the value provided by these sorts of embedded capabilities falls within the use of the platform. However, where possible, these capabilities should also work to reduce the time and effort required in implementation. While most implementations will require some degree of tailoring, organizations will reduce the amount required depending on the degree to which it will be able to use out-of-the-box components effectively.

When evaluating a GRC solution from either perspective, organizations should be mindful of the extent to which the components provided match its needs, and the ease with which those components can be further tailored to meet an organization's needs. In addition, organizations will wish to explore the industry vertical expertise of the provider as well. Optimal selections will demonstrate an awareness of both standards-based requirements and relevant industry context, expectations, and standard business processes.

Obviously, any solution should work effectively and be easy to use with minimal corrections. When GRC investments do fail, whether as a result of poor functionality alignment or IT infrastructure compatibility, the underlying causes can often be traced to poor due diligence, insufficient business process planning, a lack of IT stakeholder engagement, or (in some cases) smoke and mirrors in vendor representations. Blue Hill's Benchmark Report: How to Avoid the Worst-Case GRC Implementation provides additional guidance on the key steps organizations should take in the evaluation process. In order to effectively assess the fit of a vendor's out-of-the-box capabilities, organizations should be prepared to demand demonstrations of solution capabilities, rather than relying on vision statement articulations.

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

Cloud and Hosted Deployment

As with most enterprise applications, GRC has traditionally been available primarily through on-premises deployments on the servers within the firewall of the customer organization. GRC vendors have largely followed general software industry trends that have seen the rise of remotely hosted and cloud deployment options. While the sensitivity of the data that falls within GRC means that organizations have been somewhat slower to adopt these options than one might see among other enterprise solution markets, cloud and hosted deployment nonetheless have proven successful in minimizing deployment and lifetime ownership costs related to GRC.

Because cloud and hosted arrangements help minimize internal deployment requirements, they help to minimize costs and efforts related to hardware purchasing, installation, or integration within the existing solution ecosystem. These options can also minimize internal burdens related to maintenance, utility consumption, or solution backup.

Organizations considering these options must consider other factors, such as the data and physical security safeguards provided by the vendor, distinctions between multi-tenancy (where multiple users operate within the same software instance) or single tenancy (where each user receives its own instance) options, data center location, and other related factors. In many cases, organizations can be satisfied by demonstrations of compliance with particular data security and privacy standards. Where particularly sensitive data or risk is involved, organizations will likely find that private cloud or on-premises options will be preferable.

However, these categories can be overly simplistic, as some vendors offer hybrid deployments mixing on-premises and hosted options or single- and multi-tenant options, generally in ways that are intended to preserve the sensitivity and privacy of corporate data.

Software-as-a-Service Pricing Models

Traditional enterprise application pricing and delivery models are comprised of perpetual or multi-year software license agreements priced according to the scope of functionality and user “seats” required, plus annually reoccurring maintenance and support package subscriptions. SaaS models distribute solution license costs across the lifetime of active use through recurring (usually monthly) payments. As a result, organizations taking advantage of SaaS delivery models are able to distribute solution costs across the lifecycle of use to minimize upfront investment costs. This also helps to minimize ownership costs, as basic solution and infrastructure management becomes the responsibility of the solution provider.

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

Because SaaS models often tie cost to actual use over smaller intervals of time, they also help to maintain the flexibility of the deployed solution, permitting organizations to expand or reduce supported user bases, as well as change the functionality used with minimal additional costs or new, large-scale implementation processes. This is especially true where SaaS models are paired with cloud deployment models, which effectively puts GRC capabilities in the hands of users on an on-demand basis. Often, SaaS models also mean that implemented solutions remain "evergreen" as they are continually updated to new versions of the software, minimizing the cost and effort required for solution upgrades.

Blue Hill Solution Landscape: GRC Implementation Support

In order to assist organizations with their own GRC implementation planning and evaluation of GRC vendor support for GRC implementation challenges, Blue Hill has assembled a select Solution Landscape describing GRC vendors that demonstrate adoption of the effective implementation support components described above: (1) rapid solution deployment strategy, (2) configurability, (3) out-of-the-box components, (4) cloud and hosted deployment, and (5) SaaS pricing models. The eleven vendors described in the sections below each demonstrate attention to the implementation challenges identified by Blue Hill's research and demonstration of strong capabilities in at least three of the five components.

How to Use the Solution Landscape

Blue Hill Solution Landscapes profile a select collection of solution vendors that demonstrate responsiveness to particular market trends. As such, Blue Hill Solution Landscapes are not intended to present comprehensive indexes of providers of particular solution functionality sets. Solution Landscapes provide illustrative profiles of vendor responses to particular market needs and key comparison points. Organizations evaluating GRC solutions should use the information provided in Table 2 in order to educate themselves as to available implementation strategies and to develop a basis of comparison as they investigate their own needs and options presented.

In reviewing the Solution Landscape, organizations should use the information provided as a starting point for evaluations. While Blue Hill makes every effort to ensure that information provided is up-to-date and accurately reflects the vendor's capabilities as of the date of publication, the levels of detail provided can vary depending on public information available and the scope of vendor discussion. Vendors not included in the Solution Landscape either declined to participate in Blue Hill research processes or failed to qualify for inclusion by showing at least three of the five implementation effectiveness components identified above.

In all cases, direct vendor inquiry and assessment is recommended.

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

Table 2: Summary of Configurable Solution Components and Implementation Support Strategies

Vendor	Solution Focus	Configurable Elements	Implementation Support
Agiliance	**Enterprise / Operational Risk Management**	• Data elements & relationships • Process workflow • User Interface • Reports & dashboards	• Professional support services support implementation phases within 60 to 90 days for on-premises implementations • Agiliance QuickStart Implementation Cloud Service provides experienced consultants to tailor a RiskVision cloud deployment to unique project needs • Best practices guides, user forums, how-to-videos, after sales support, and training programs
AssurX	**Regulatory and Quality Management**	• Process workflow • User interface • Reports & dashboards	• Quick Deployment includes support for launch, system installation, configuration, and deployment • Further validation, integration, customization, data migration, and training services available
DoubleCheck Software	**Enterprise GRC**	• Data elements & relationships • Process workflow • User Interface • Reports & dashboards	• Three-tiers of implementation support, including "Quick Start" support, configuration services, and unique feature development • "Helping Hands" solution success consulting
Enablon	**Operational Risk**	• Data elements & relationships • Process workflow • User Interface • Reports & dashboards	• IRIS methodology for traditional support within a four to six month target • QuickStart implementation for rapid, highly collaborative deployment of templatized product configuration within a four-week target • Customer best practices exchange community
LockPath	**Enterprise GRC & Security**	• Data elements & relationships • Process workflow • User Interface • Reports & dashboards	• QuickStart focuses on core steps to go-live within 30 days • QuickPath adds configuration services to support client success • Keylight and LockPath professional services are offered for free for the first sixty days
LogicManager	**Enterprise Risk Management**	• Data elements & relationships • Process workflow • Reports & dashboards	• Library of best practice frameworks and regulatory templates • Guaranteed initial set-up within 5 days and go-live within 90 days • "Getting Started" and dedicated, unlimited ongoing consulting services
MetricStream	**Enterprise GRC**	• Data elements & relationships • Process workflow • User Interface • Reports & dashboards	• Bundled implementation, deployment and configuration packages • Best practices, maturity framework and methodology • ComplianceOnline.com network of best practices, training, and content • After sales support and training programs
NASDAQ OMX BWise	**Enterprise GRC**	• Data elements & relationships • Process workflow • Reports & dashboards	• Rapid Deployment services draw from best practices and pre-defined formats for solution frameworks, workflows, roles, and dashboards • Spiral Implementation methodologies support larger deployments through formal prototyping and stage-gate processes • Center of Excellence support for complex and multi-use case needs
Resolver	**Enterprise GRC**	• Data elements & relationships • Process workflow • Reports & dashboards	• Quick implementations empathize iterative processes prioritizing time to use while permitting further tweaking following use experience
Rsam	**IT GRC**	• Data elements & relationships • Process workflow • User interface • Reports & dashboards	• QuickStart program provides consultants to assist in need identification, solution configuration, and deployment plan development with a focus on short-term business value

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

SAP	**Enterprise GRC**	• Data elements & relationships • Process workflow • User interface • Reports & dashboards	• Rapid Deployment services focus on providing a 70 day go-live cycle • Additional consulting services and SAP ONE Support available • SAP GRC Strategy Selector app for structured self-assessment

Agiliance

Source: Blue Hill Research, August 2015

Agiliance provides IT, enterprise, and operational risk management solutions through its RiskVision platform. Core solution capabilities offered include: risk management, policy management, compliance management, incident management, threat and vulnerability management, vendor risk management, business continuity, and continuous IT compliance and monitoring.

Deployment Options: On-premises
Private cloud including hosting, administration, and implementation

Pricing Options: Perpetual license and maintenance
Annual subscription

Configurable Elements: Data Elements, Data Relationships, Process Workflow, User Interface, Reports and Dashboards, Graphical Workflow Development Engine

Out-of-the-Box Components

Content Frameworks: Over 50 content sources, including FedRAMP, HIPPA, ISO, NERC CIP, NIST, PCI, FFIEC, MAS, NEI 08-09, FISMA, COBIT, BITS, CSA, OCC, COSO, OCTAVE-Allegro, DISA, SANS, SCAP, Shared Assessments

Connectors & Integrations: Microsoft Office, generic database and web services connectors, and integrations with over 70 IT and security tools, such as: configuration management, vulnerability management, event management, database security, threat management applications and data sources, and business applications

Rapid Deployment Strategy

Agiliance deployment and configuration tools and pre-built capabilities are intended to support self-directed and efficient implementation and modification. These efforts are further supported by self-service resources such as best practices guides, user forums, and how-to-videos as well as after-sales support and training programs. Professional and implementation support services aid implementation phases from requirements development and solution planning to user acceptance testing and go-live launch, as well as custom content, report, and workflow development. Agiliance QuickStart Implementation Cloud Service provides experienced consultants to tailor a RiskVision cloud deployment to unique project needs.

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

AssurX

With roots in life sciences and utilities industry quality and compliance challenges, AssurX has evolved to offer full enterprise GRC across industry verticals. Core solution capabilities offered include: risk management, policy management, compliance management, quality management, supplier quality and risk, incident management, and audit management.

Deployment Options:	On-premises Single-tenant hosted application
Pricing Options:	Perpetual license and maintenance Annual subscription
Configurable Elements:	Process Workflow, User Interface, Reports and Dashboards

Out-of-the-Box Components

Content Frameworks:	Various NERC Reliability Standards, Objectives/Risks Templates, Controls Library Templates, and the ability to import custom frameworks via spreadsheet
Connectors & Integrations:	MS Office, Lotus Notes, SQL, Oracle, Salesforce, and a range of ERP and MES providers.

Rapid Deployment Strategy

AssurX Quick Deployment supports launch, system installation, configuration, and deployment. Validation, integration, customization, data migration, and training services are also available.

DoubleCheck Software

DoubleCheck Software develops unified enterprise GRC platforms. Core solution capabilities offered include: enterprise risk management, policy management, compliance management, vendor risk management, audit management, and Embedded Business Intelligence for GRC.

Deployment Options:	On-premises Dedicated, single-instance private cloud deployment
Pricing Options:	Annual subscription with multi-year term
Configurable Elements:	Data Elements, Data Relationships, Process Workflow, User Interface, Reports and Dashboards, Auto-Notification and Reports, User Workbenches and Assessments

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

Out-of-the-Box Components

Content Frameworks:	Pre-Configured Base Modules for Enterprise Risk Management, Vendor Risk Management, Compliance Management, Policy, Internal Audit, Integrated Risk-based Audit Planning, Configurable Enterprise Assessment engine, and Integrated BI platform. Frameworks supported in these modules include: COSO 2013, SOX Internal Controls, NAIC Model Audit Rule, JSOX, PCI, COBIT, OMB A-123, ISO, HIPAA, and OCC.
Connectors & Integrations:	MS Office, SAML, third-party Single Sign-on providers, email, embedded integration of the TIBCO Jaspersoft BI platform, content feed connectors, configurable connector for Excel imports, custom connectors to various business applications and data source.

Rapid Deployment Strategy

DoubleCheck offers a wide selection of training options and three tiers of implementation support. "Quick Start" provides best practices deployment supporting pre-defined formats, data imports for solution frameworks, workflows, roles, dashboards, and particular use cases. "Custom Configured Deployment" options provide professional services to support implementation phases from requirements development and solution planning to user acceptance testing and go-live launch, along with business analytic reports, visualization, and workflow development, and unique feature development. "Standard Support," supplemented by DoubleCheck "Helping Hands" solution success consulting options, is included with software license.

Enablon

Enablon's Enterprise Control solution provides an Enterprise Risk Management and GRC solution with core capabilities in: enterprise and operational risk management, audit and compliance management, policy management, corporate governance and responsibility, incident / event management, internal audit, internal control and continuous assessment, business continuity management, insurance and claims management, asset management, actions plans and management of change.

Enablon also offers dedicated solutions for health and safety management, environmental management, supply-chain management, sustainability performance management and chemical management.

Deployment Options:	On-premises Single- and multi-tenant hosted options
Pricing Options:	Perpetual license and maintenance Subscription

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

Configurable Elements: Data Elements, Data Relationships, Process Workflow, Reports and Dashboards, Drag-and-drop Workflow, Form, and Report Configuration

Out-of-the-Box Components

Content Frameworks: ISO 31000, ISO 14001, ISO 22000, HACCP, SQF, EMAS, REACH, OHSAS 18001, FDA FSMA, Basel II, Basel III, Solvency II

Vertical-oriented workflow and best practices packages including: oil and gas, chemicals, life sciences, and manufacturing and best practices packages including: oil and gas, chemicals, life sciences, and manufacturing

Connectors & Integrations: Enablon has a range of options to connect to third party systems via flat files import/export, APIs and WebServices

Rapid Deployment Strategy

Enablon offers two main implementation options: IRIS and QuickStart. IRIS implementation and deployment methodology provides traditional implementation services and deep configuration and customization options. QuickStart" implementation methodology focuses on business support, solution planning, and incremental deployment with a targeted four-week engagement cycle.

The company also offers common configuration packages for frequent or simple GRC needs in order to shorten implementation time and cost. Standard configuration options are built on past Enablon projects and identified best practices. Enablon also manages a customer community intended to facilitate the exchange of best practices for implementation, maintenance, and use of the solution.

LockPath

LockPath provides IT GRC and security solutions through its Keylight platform. Core solution capabilities include: risk management, policy management, compliance management, security threat and intelligence, vendor risk and compliance, incident management, business continuity, and audit management.

Deployment Options: On-premises
Multi-tenant hosted application environment with individualized database instances

Pricing Options: *On-premises*: Perpetual license and maintenance
Hosted: Subscription and perpetual license and maintenance

Configurable Elements: Data Elements, Data Relationships, Process Workflow, Reports and Dashboards, User Authorization, User Interfaces, Drag-and-Drop Configuration

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

Out-of-the-Box Components

Content Frameworks: Dodd-Frank Conflict Minerals, NERC CIP, PCI, FFIEC, HIPAA, FERPA, ISO 27001/2, SSAE 16, NIST, COBIT, PCI DSS, SOX, UCF

Connectors & Integrations: Third-party intelligence, SIEM, data, analytics, SysLogs, and content feeds, including: Acunetix, BeyondTrust Retina, Intel Security/McAfee VM, HP WebInspect, IBM Rational Scan, IBM QRadar, Tenable, nMap, OpenVas, Qualys VM, Qualys WAS, Rapid7, Whitehat, Intel Security/McAfee, BT Assure, Qualys PC, Tripwire IP360, iSIGHT Partners, Syslog, RedSeal Networks, Veracode, Tinfoil Security, and email. LockPath also offers an RSS feed collector and Ambassador multipurpose automated import tool.

Rapid Deployment Strategy

LockPath rapid deployment support includes QuickStart and QuickPath options. QuickStart focuses on core deployment needs to get a client live within a 30-day window. QuickPath provides additional configuration services to support on-going client success.

LogicManager

LogicManager develops enterprise risk management and GRC solutions. Core solution capabilities include: enterprise risk management, policy management, corporate governance and responsibility, compliance management, IT GRC, incident management, vendor risk management, business continuity management, audit management, sustainability management, and EH&S management core capabilities.

Deployment Options: Multi-tenant cloud deployment
Single-tenant, privately hosted options available

Pricing Options: Subscription packages ranging from 90 day to annual terms
Multi-year packages available for planned deployments over five years

Configurable Elements: Data Elements, Data Relationships, Process Workflow, Reports and Dashboards

Out-of-the-Box Components

Content Frameworks: COSO, Six Sigma, ISO 9000, ISO 19600, ISO 22000, FDA, USDA, NAIC ORS, PCI DSS, RIMS, FINRA, NERC, FERC, SOX, FFIEC, FERPA, HIPAA, CMMI, OSHA

Connectors & Integrations: RSS and email readers as well as open API's for automated data collection

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

Rapid Deployment Strategy

LogicManager is dedicated to enabling customers to launch GRC without IT involvement to permit focus on business requirements, training, data import, and self-service configuration. The company guarantees complete technical implementation within a five-day window. It also maintains a library of best practice frameworks and regulatory templates to facilitate plug-in deployment for industry and solution content based on customer use of the solution. LogicManager assigns a dedicated business analyst to each customer with a focus on completing initial set-up, training, and business adoption within a 90 day window, which can be extended for the lifetime of the subscription at a flat-rate to assist with on-going business support needs, such as best practice recommendation, data retrofitting, and customer report development.

MetricStream

MetricStream is an enterprise GRC provider with solution core capabilities in: enterprise risk management, policy management, corporate governance and responsibility, compliance management, IT GRC, incident management, legal matter management, vendor risk management, supplier risk management, business continuity, audit management, contract management, trade management, social media risk, quality management, sustainability management, and EH&S management.

Deployment Options:	On-premises Single- and multi-tenant hosted options
Pricing Options:	Perpetual license and maintenance Subscription
Configurable Elements:	Data Elements, Data Relationships, Process Workflow, User Interface, Reports and Dashboards, Drag-and-drop Configuration

Out-of-the-Box Components

Content Frameworks:	UCF, ISO 27002/17799, ISO 16949, COBIT, FCPA, Basel II & III, NERC, NIST, FCPA, EH&S, FDA, SOX, Dodd-Frank, Medicare, HIPAA, COBIT, Solvency II Vertical-oriented workflow and best practices packages
Connectors & Integrations:	Infolet adaptor connectors to flat file, Message Bus, direct APIs, and web services

Rapid Deployment Strategy

The MetricStream GRC platform utilizes a scalable infrastructure intended to permit users to roll out small projects that can subsequently scale to include expanded corporate use cases and user pools. MetricStream offers bundled implementation, professional services and configuration packages in

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

support of customer implementations as well as a range of packaged offerings to meet large enterprise as well as mid-size requirements. The provider utilizes defined best practices, maturity framework and methodology to guide short-term and long-term success and its ComplianceOnline.com customer network to provide customers with best practices, training, and content developed by peer organizations. Further after-sales support and training programs are also available.

Nasdaq BWise

Nasdaq BWise is a business process management and enterprise GRC platform provider. Core solution capabilities offered include: enterprise risk management, policy management, corporate governance and responsibility, compliance management, IT GRC, incident management, audit management, sustainability management, and EH&S management.

Deployment Options:	On-premises Cloud deployment
Pricing Options:	Perpetual license and maintenance Subscription
Configurable Elements:	Data Elements, Data Relationships, Process Workflow, Reports and Dashboards, User Authorizations

Out-of-the-Box Components

Content Frameworks:	COBIT, SAS 70, UCF, Basel IIII, Dodd-Frank, SOX, FERC, NERC, FCPA, UK Bribery Act, Solvency II, Tumbull, SSAE 18, MAR, MiFID, PCI, HIPAA, FIPS 191, UETA, NASD Manual, ISO 27002, UCF
Connectors & Integrations:	Integrations possible with third-party applications, regulatory content providers, and quantitative risk management tools

Rapid Deployment Strategy

BWise Rapid Deployment Solutions draw from existing customer best practices supporting pre-defined formats for solution frameworks, workflows, roles, and dashboards supporting particular use cases. Spiral Implementation methodologies support larger deployments through formal prototyping and stage-gate processes. The company also makes Center of Excellence support available for complex and multi-use case deployments.

Resolver

Resolver provides an enterprise GRC platform with core capabilities in: risk management, policy management, corporate governance and responsibility, compliance management, IT GRC, incident management, audit management, and vendor management.

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

Deployment Options: On-premises
Multi-instance application environment with single-tenant data centers

Pricing Options: Perpetual license and maintenance
Subscription

Configurable Elements: Data Elements, Data Relationships, Process Workflow, Reports and Dashboards

Out-of-the-Box Components

Content Frameworks: ISO 27001, ISO 27002, ISO 31000, PCI, SOX, COSO 2013, NIST, COBIT, Extractive Industries Transparency Initiative, NERC, FERC, FCPA, IAA, HIPAA

Connectors & Integrations: LDAP connectors, ERP integrations including Oracle, SAP, and Microsoft

Rapid Deployment Strategy

Resolver quick implementations emphasize iterative processes focused on helping users getting solutions live and tweaking implementations based on implementation experience and value.

Rsam

Rsam provides IT GRC solutions with core capabilities in: enterprise risk management, policy management, exception management, incident management, regulatory change management, audit management, vendor risk management, financial controls management, business continuity management, and risk intelligence.

Deployment Options: On-premises

Pricing Options: Perpetual license and maintenance

Configurable Elements: Data Elements, Data Relationships, Process Workflow, Reports and Dashboards, User Interface, Reports and Dashboard, Graphical Customization Interface

Out-of-the-Box Components

Content Frameworks: BITS, COBIT, FFIEC, FISMA, GLBA, HIPAA, HITRUST, NERC, NIST, PCI, SOX, and user-driven best practices

Connectors & Integrations: *[Information not provided]*

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

Rapid Deployment Strategy

The Rsam GRC framework employs modular deployment and is pre-configured with out-of-the-box capabilities and a graphical customization interface. Rsam's QuickStart program provides consultants who assist in need identification, solution configuration, and deployment plan development with a focus on short-term business value. Additional training, remote admin services, and long-term customer success consulting options are available.

SAP

SAP develops and provides a variety of GRC offerings available both as standalone or integrated solution deployments. Core capabilities include: enterprise risk management, access governance, audit management, controls and regulatory change management, fraud management, and international trade management. In addition, the vendor offers an SAP Fiori Enterprise Reporting app, as well as a dedicated financial institution risk management solution.

Deployment Options:	On-premises HANA Enterprise Cloud deployment Partner-hosted offerings Hybrid on-premises and hosted environments
Pricing Options:	Perpetual license and maintenance Subscription packages Value-added reseller supported licensing and financing options
Configurable Elements:	Data Elements, Data Relationships, Process Workflow, Reports and Dashboards, User Interface

Out-of-the-Box Components

Content Frameworks:	Audit templates, EH&S standards, controls libraries, taxonomies, KRIs, and other content as well as out-of-the-box, use case-specific configurations within particular industries or functional areas
Connectors & Integrations:	Integrations across the GRC solution sets and the broader SAP product portfolio are available SAP HANA in-memory database system provides search and analysis that can reach across structured and unstructured data types

Rapid Deployment Strategy

SAP Rapid Deployment services focus on getting users using a running module within 70 days from launch with a focus on identified business objectives. The company also offers additional consulting

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

services and SAP ONE Support. For organizations planning for GRC investments, the SAP GRC Strategy Selector app permits users to do their own structured self-assessment of risks and risk strategies.

Key Observations and Recommendations

The maturing vendor response to GRC implementation complexity and cost challenges presents a major category of differentiation and potential value to consider in solution evaluations. Blue Hill identified five categories of vendor focus on implementation success and support: (1) rapid solution deployment strategy, (2) configurability, (3) out-of-the-box components, (4) cloud and hosted deployment, and (5) SaaS pricing models. Collectively, the vendors identified in this landscape, along with other GRC providers, have developed capabilities in these categories in order to improve the cost and time of implementation, as well as enhance ultimate time-to-value in GRC investment. As such, these factors deserve consideration alongside functionality, solution cost, support services, and other investment factors.

Of course, efforts to shorten and reduce the cost of implementation cycles should not be the only factors considered. In the absence of other concerns, short and cheap can result in a solution with poor fit to organizational needs and very little substantive impact. Large, complex, and sophisticated GRC deployments can and should last longer than more modest investments. Nonetheless, early experiences with GRC implementation have demonstrated that the process can also be overly complicated and involve needless costs. However, where solution functionality, cost, and software quality are roughly equal, the ability of a vendor to provide for rapid implementation will have a major impact on the time-to-value, perceived success, and the ultimate ROI involved. It is in this light – as a component rather than a determinant of success – that we should consider the evaluation of vendor efforts to simplify and accelerate the implementation and deployment process.

Internal planning and implementation strategy development play a key role in implementation success as well. To this end, Blue Hill's Benchmark Report: How to Avoid the Worst-Case GRC Implementation provided the following recommendations:

- Build from a clear vision of business needs and process change
- Align implementation milestones to business value requirements
- Involve IT at the earliest stage of the investment
- Seek configurability over customization, where possible

Incorporating the evaluation of vendor strategies for implementation efficiency and effectiveness requires additional steps in both investment planning and vendor evaluation. This involves a preliminary inquiry into whether and how the organization is positioned to take advantage of these various components. Key steps in this evaluation include:

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

- Upfront requirements and business objective mapping to identify the GRC capabilities needed
- Evaluation of internal maturity and specialized needs that require departure from standard, out-of-the-box best practices and frameworks
- Assessment of the depth and ease of solution configurability options to determine the extent to which customization is truly required
- Evaluation of corporate and industry technology and security requirements to assess fit of vendor technology deployment methods and solution architecture
- Assessment of the degree to which incremental implementation strategies can be employed, and vendor support for modular and scalable deployment

These steps will help organizations to understand the extent to which the implementation support components identified will be available. As organizations conduct these steps and determine their options, they will become able to determine how to compare these factors to other elements of GRC evaluation, and assess how their decisions will impact the overall ROI and time-to-value of the investment.

Copyright © 2015 Blue Hill Research

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

David Houlihan

Principal Analyst

David Houlihan researches enterprise risk management, compliance and policy management, and legal technology. He is an experienced advisor in legal and technology fields with a unique understanding of complex information environments and business legal needs.



CONNECT ON SOCIAL MEDIA

@DWHoulihan

www.linkedin.com/in/houlihandavid

bluehillresearch.com/author/david-houlihan/

For further information or questions, please contact us:

***Phone**: +1 (617)624-3600*
***Fax** : +1 (617)367-4210*

***Twitter**: @BlueHillBoston*
***LinkedIn:** www.linkedin.com/company/blue-hill-research*

***Contact Research**: research@bluehillresearch.com*

Blue Hill Research is the only industry analyst firm with a success-based methodology. Based on the Path to Success, Blue Hill Research provides unique and differentiated guidance to translate corporate technology investments into success for the three key stakeholders: the technologist, the financial buyer, and the line of business executive.

Unless otherwise noted, the contents of this publication are copyrighted by Blue Hill Research and may not be hosted, archived, transmitted or reproduced, in any form or by any means without prior permission from Blue Hill Research.